David Friedman as ambassador, a man who would probably agree with Bushinsky's criticism.

The new ambassador has no diplomatic experience. He worked as Trump's bankruptcy lawyer, and then served as a quasi-official Middle East adviser during the campaign. He supports Israeli settlements in the occupied territories, and not just rhetorically—he was the president of a foundation that donated millions of dollars to a yeshiva in Beit El, outside of Ramallah. In a private 2016 meeting with a group of settler leaders, he argued that Israel could annex the entire West Bank while retaining its Jewish identity.

President Obama, he said, was an anti-Semite. Huma Abedin, one of Hillary Clinton's top aides (and a Muslim), was a secret member of the Muslim Brotherhood. Perhaps the most jarring slur, though, was directed at American Jews who support a two-state solution, particularly the lobby group J Street. He compared them to *kapos*, the prisoners in Nazi concentration camps who were put in charge of other inmates. "They are far worse than *kapos*", he wrote in a commentary for *Arutz Sheva*, a right-wing Israeli website affiliated with the settler movement. "The *kapos* faced extraordinary cruelty and who knows what any of us would have done under those circumstances to save a loved one? But J Street? They are just smug advocates of Israel's destruction delivered from the comfort of their secure American sofas."

"A United States that no longer exists"

Donald Trump will be the president who breaks the pro-Israel lobby in the United States. It sounds absurd, of course. Aside from Friedman, his Israel advisers also include his son-in-law, Jared Kushner, whose family runs a foundation that funnels tens of thousands of dollars to West Bank settlements (including at least one extremist *yeshiva*). Steve Bannon, his top adviser, was invited to speak at a far-right Zionist Organization of America dinner just days after the election. The Israel lobby seems to be on good terms with the new administration. And it is—but only a part of it.

The Brookings Institution, one of the more staid think tanks in DC, hosts an event called the Saban Forum, a yearly affirmation of the US–Israel relationship. (It is named after Haim Saban, the Israeli-American billionaire and Power Rangers producer who is a top donor to the Democratic Party.) Each year, they present a survey on American attitudes toward the Israeli-